

Riparian planting guide

Spacing, stock and timing for streambank restoration · Version 2

When to plant

Plant dormant stock between late November and early March, after the first soaking rain and before buds break. Cuttings root best when soil stays moist for six weeks after planting.

Spacing by zone

Zone	Distance from water	Spacing	Typical stock
Toe	0–2 m	1 m	Willow cuttings, sedge plugs
Bank	2–6 m	2 m	Alder, dogwood, rose
Terrace	6–20 m	4 m	Cottonwood, oak, elderberry

Protecting new plants

Cage every tree on the bank and terrace zones where deer or beaver are present. Mulch a 1 m circle around each plant, and keep it clear of the stem.

Survival checks

Count living plants by zone at 1, 3 and 5 years. Replant any zone below 70% survival in the next dormant season.

Check	When	Target survival
Year 1	September	85%
Year 3	September	75%
Year 5	September	70%

Recording

Enter survival counts on the project's performance measures the same month they are taken, with one photo from each photo point.